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NERVES OF STEEL

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An eventful year in the Ultimate Fighting Championship came to a close on December 15, with France's Joaquin Buckley handing welterweight veteran Colby Covington his second consecutive loss.

Fans had their fair share of excitement, disappointment, and surprise in the year that went by, which saw 41 UFC events in total, including 19 title fights.

From India's own Puja Tomar's historic win to Jon Jones' victory that forced Stipe Miocic into retirement, here are the top five fights of 2024 (clockwise):

Jon Jones still going strong

Jones defended his heavyweight title with a technical knockout win over Miocic midway through the third round at UFC 309 in November.

Jones, who had been sidelined due to a pectoral injury for over a

year, returned to the Octagon with a strategic approach. He utilised his superior grappling and striking skills to control the pace of the fight.

Miocic, despite a three-and-a-half-year hiatus, showcased his power and resilience. The bout was competitive, with both fighters having their moments. Ultimately, Jones secured victory by technical knockout in the third round, solidifying his legacy in the heavyweight division.

Islam Makhachev continues domination

The lightweight title fight between Islam Makhachev and Dustin Poirier, which lasted almost the full quota of five rounds, was nothing short of extraordinary.

The champion wasted no time putting Poirier on the canvas early in the first round, swiftly advancing to take his back and maintaining control there for the remainder of the round.

Poirier showed solid defensive skills throughout, and the rest of the

fight became a gritty and competitive affair, with the challenger doing an impressive job of thwarting takedowns while Makhachev found himself drawn into the first bloody and gruelling battle of his reign as champion.

Midway through the final round, Makhachev made Poirier stumble for one last time before opting for the D'Arce choke, which forced the latter to tap out.

Max Holloway all the way

Max Holloway was crowned the latest BMF title winner (viewer discretion advised if searching for its full form). Right after Holloway's fight against Justin Gaethje ended, a person on X posted: "This is why the BMF belt was made." The fight was of the highest quality, with Holloway knocking out Gaethje with just one second to spare.

Until the final and fifth round, the fight was evenly poised, with both fighters trading blows at regular intervals. However, when everything pointed towards a decision win for